

You(th) are here: Redesigning YSB Drop-in Postings

Information • Accessibility • Autonomy

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Context

“What if one of the biggest barriers to addressing accessibility isn’t lack of access to services but lack of access to information?”

Background

Problem Statement

People experiencing **homelessness with disabilities** who use temporary and transitional support spaces often cannot reliably get **clear, accurate, and accessible information** about what services exist, which options actually meet their needs, and how to access them.

(Canadian Human Rights Commission, 2024; City of Toronto, 2025; Employment and Social Development Canada, 2023; Piercey, 2025)

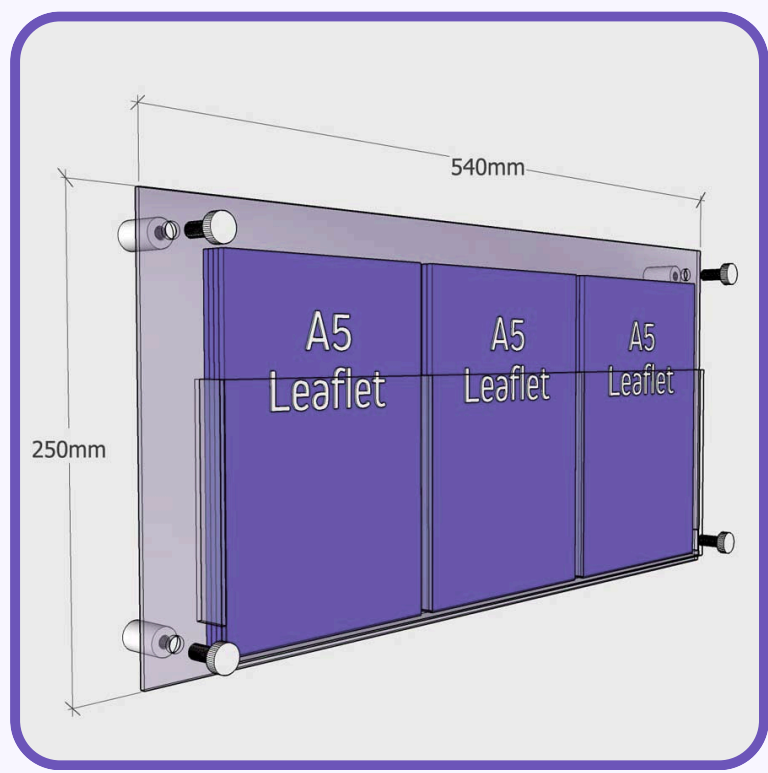
Project Goal

- Improve the existing information sharing system at the **YSB Downtown Drop-In** Center, making communication tools accessible to a wider range of abilities, including those with **ABI and cognitive, learning, and developmental disabilities**
- Move away from sole reliance on dense text and verbal instructions at check-in
- Support more residents in navigating the space **independently and with dignity**

Concept

3-Component Assembly

1. **Holder:** Semi-permanent letter paper multi-sheet holder affixed to the wall
2. **Key information:** standard letter-size paper sheet with reference information
3. **Maps:** Static close-up map (paper) + interactive area map (online)

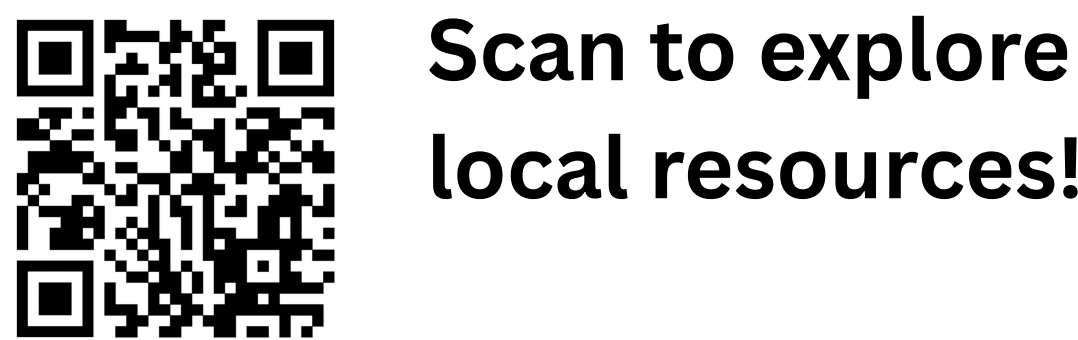
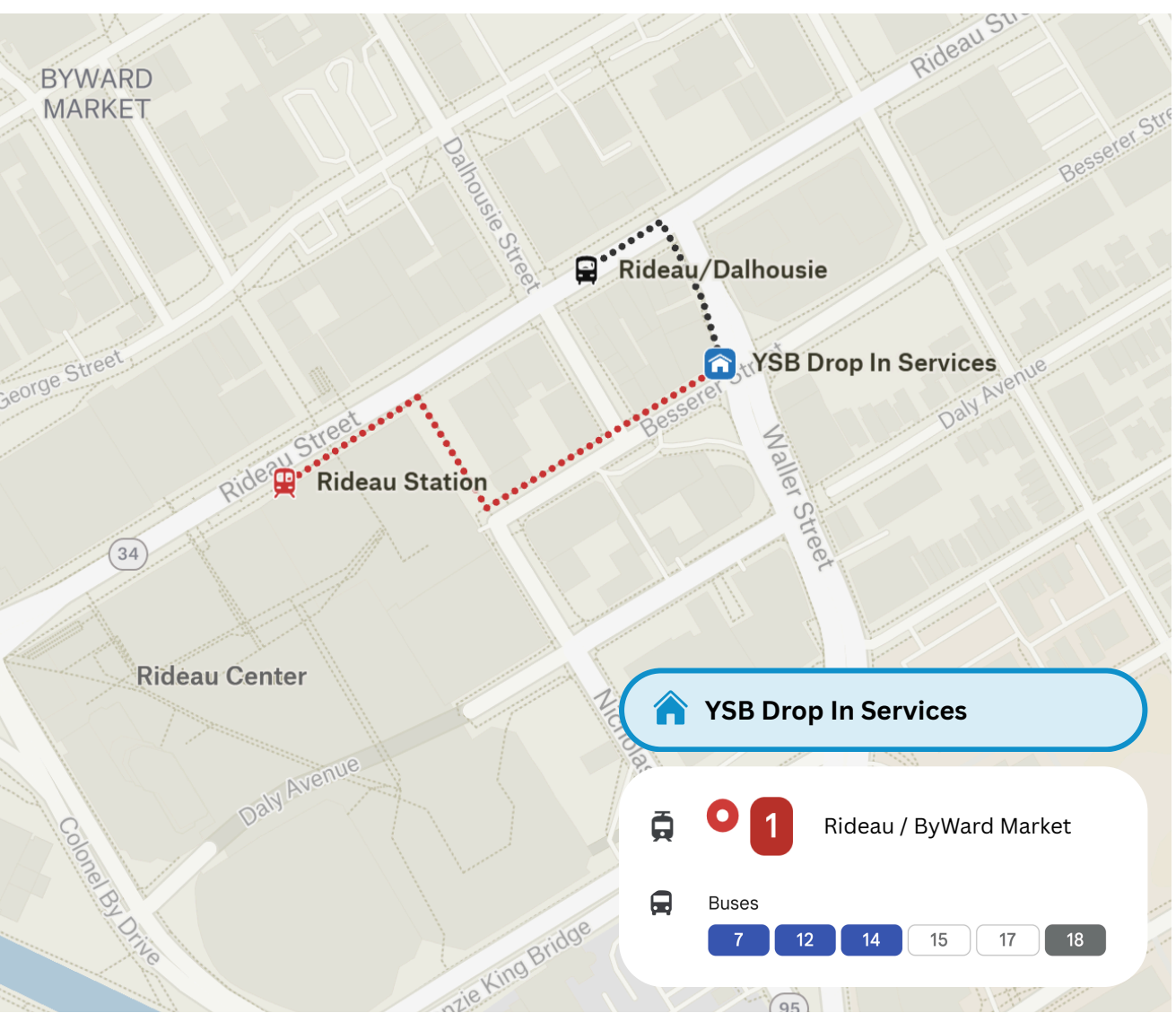


Dimensions Displays

SDG Alignment

- SDG 3 — Good Health and Well-Being
- SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities
- SDG 16 — Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions

Result



Scan to explore local resources!

Project Continuation

- Take-home fliers for outreach purposes
- Lens in map (live VR navigation)
- Interactive widget map upgrade for ysb.ca

Info Sheet

YSB Consistent Design

- Colours:**
- Greyscale #000000 to #ffffff
 - Azure #0f90ca
- Fonts:**
- Titling - Oswald Bold
 - Body text - Lato Regular
- Messaging:**
- Clean, simple, clear

Wayfinding Map

Physical Close-up Map

Location: Info sheet
Features: Nearest transit route, simple

Digital Interactive Map

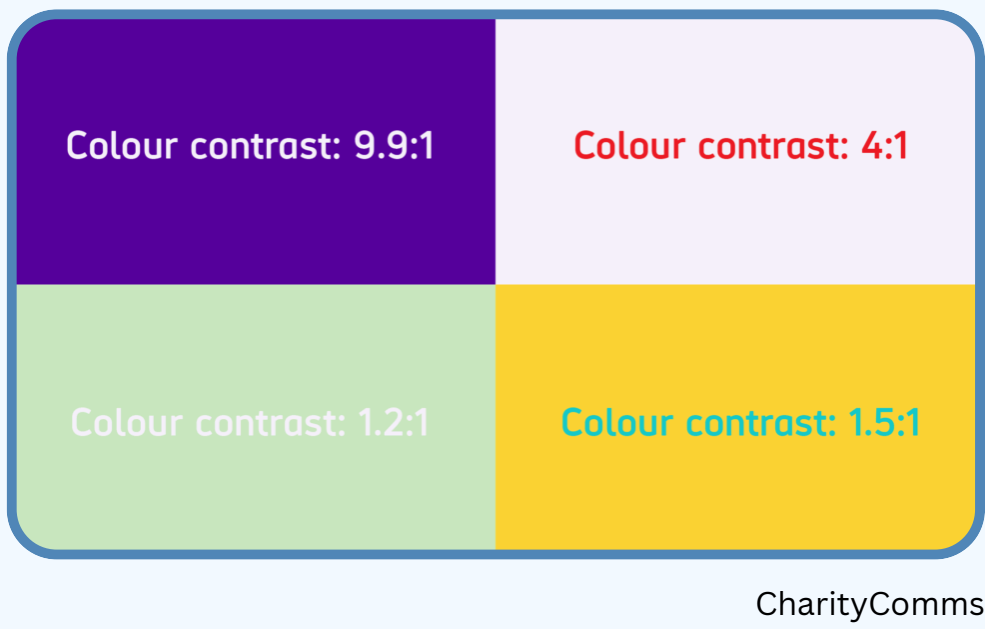
- Location:** Accessible online through a QR code (located on info sheets)
- Features:**
- Show/Hide layers for different resource categories such as hospitals and libraries
 - Includes other centers and shelters that could work alternatively or in conjunction with the YSB Drop In

Design Research

Accessibility Checklist

From Research (AODA, CharityComms):

- Colour
 - Contrast ratio > 4:1
 - Avoid Red/Green (colourblindness)
 - Avoid Neons (reduce overstimulation)
- Type size > 12pt-14pt
- Letter and line spacing > 1
- Simple language, reduced text
- Images and icons (large)
- Bilingual (FR/EN)
- Information grouping and hierarchy (clear size and spacing difference)



CharityComms

Intentional Design Choices

- Visual redundancy (e.g., icon + colour + shape + text)
- Colour and positional separation of FR/EN for clarity
- Information hierarchy (e.g., 1. top + bottom 2. services 3. map 4. text)

Stakeholder Discussions

YSB Representative

- Key Takeaways:
- Most of the youth they serve have access to a mobile phone, making online resources and QR codes a realistic choice
 - Drop-in location requires a more welcoming tone, and other YSB resources should be more practical

Persons Living with Dyslexia and/or ADHD

- Key Takeaways:
- More is not necessarily better when it comes to line spacing - double line spacing is harder to read than 1.5
 - Emphasis on character distinction without total separation and thoughtful information grouping
 - Interactive elements promote more active use